Reconstruction Plans: Lincoln's Ten Percent Plan

President Abraham Lincoln · December 8, 1863

Source: Lincoln, Proclamation of Amnesty and Reconstruction (1863). Public domain. The “ten percent” provision.

> Lincoln's lenient wartime blueprint for readmitting Confederate states: pardon most Southerners who swore loyalty and accepted emancipation, and let a state rejoin once one-tenth of its 1860 voters took the oath. Radical Republicans countered with the far stricter Wade-Davis Bill (1864).

Whenever, in any of the States . . . in rebellion, a number of persons, not less than one tenth in number of the votes cast in such state at the presidential election of the year . . . one thousand eight hundred and sixty, each having taken the oath aforesaid, and not having since violated it . . . shall reestablish a state government which shall be republican . . . such shall be recognized as the true government of the state.